

Executive Summary — Phase 1: Market Discovery and Product Validation

This phase analyzes the earliest operational stage of the food business, where the business operated on a single-plate model designed to test market demand, customer preferences, and pricing flexibility. Using reconstructed historical operational data based on product pricing memory, customer behavior patterns, and menu performance recall, the analysis evaluates product viability, profitability, and operational efficiency.

The findings show that beef-based dishes formed the strongest foundation of the business, dominating both menu frequency and customer demand. Dishes such as Rice and Beef, Chapati and Beef, and Beef Pilau consistently generated the highest gross margins and margin efficiency, highlighting beef as the core revenue driver during the early stage of operations.

The analysis also revealed that simpler dishes with lower operational complexity, such as Masala Fries, delivered some of the strongest profit margins. This suggests that operational simplicity played a major role in maximizing returns during the market discovery stage.

A key insight from the analysis was the disconnect between customer preference and profitability. While some dishes, such as Ugali and Fish, maintained moderate customer preference, their lower profitability exposed the limitations of keeping products based purely on customer demand without considering operational cost.

Product survival analysis showed a 90% menu retention rate, indicating strong early product-market fit. However, Ugali and Chicken emerged as the weakest-performing product due to low demand, irregular sales, and rising protein costs, eventually leading to its removal from the menu.

Overall, Phase 1 demonstrates that the business successfully identified its strongest products, validated customer preferences, and established a profitable menu foundation. These insights created the operational knowledge necessary for the business to transition into a more scalable catering and corporate package model in Phase 2.